

Will McGowan: 35 Graduate Applications, 2027 Entry

Compiled 6 October 2026. Five roles in each of seven industries, each followed by a tailored cover letter built from your template. Only the firm hook and the firm paragraph change; every other sentence is yours, unchanged. The touchpoint sentence has been left out because you have no contact at these firms yet. Add one if you meet someone from a firm.

Check before sending: (1) the posting is still open, (2) the programme name matches the careers page exactly, (3) the office address, (4) the firm name in the letter and the file name. Save each letter as Will_McGowan_CoverLetter_Firm.pdf.

#	Firm / programme	Location	Status / deadline	CV	Notes
INVESTMENT BANKING					
1	Lazard: 2027 London Financial Advisory Full-Time Analyst Programme	London	Open. For students finishing in 2027 or recent graduates; analyst programme starts late July 2027.	Banking PE Consulting	https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/2027-london-financial-advisory-full-time-analyst-245479
2	J.P. Morgan: 2027 Global Investment Banking Analyst Program (Full-Time)	London	Open. Deadline 1 November 2026.	Banking PE Consulting	Confirm the London location when you open the posting. https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/2027-global-investment-banking-analyst-program-full-time-247319
3	Houlihan Lokey: 2027 Graduate Financial Analyst – Corporate Finance (M&A)	London	Listed for 2027 (training starts 14 June 2027). Deadline not shown.	Banking PE Consulting	Check that the posting accepts final-year students, because one listing mentioned penultimate-year students. https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/houlihan-lokey/2027-graduate-financial-analyst-corporate-finance-ma
4	Goldman Sachs: 2027 EMEA London Investment Banking New Analyst Programme	London	New Analyst Programme open to 2027 graduates; you can apply to up to 4 division/location combinations.	Banking PE Consulting	Use one of your four GS choices here and one for the S&T role (#15). https://www.goldmansachs.com/careers/students/programs-and-internships/emea/new-analyst-programme
5	Rothschild & Co: Evergreen – 2027 Global Advisory Graduate Programme	London	Register-interest ('Evergreen') pool. Rothschild says it is not currently hiring for 2027 graduates but will consider this pool first if places open. Starts July 2027.	Banking PE Consulting	Low effort, worth submitting. https://www.rothschildandco.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates/opportunities/evergreen-2027-global-advisory-graduate-programme-london/
PRIVATE EQUITY					
6	British International Investment: 2027 Investment and Impact Graduate Analyst Programme	London	Opened 28 September 2026, reviewed on a rolling basis. Needs a 2:1 and the permanent right to work in the UK.	Banking PE Consulting	Short form plus a motivation question. Reuse the firm paragraph there. https://www.bii.co.uk/en/careers/investment-and-impact-graduate-analyst-programme/
7	Partners Group: Portfolio & Quant Analyst (new graduate level)	London	Open new-graduate role in London.	Asset Management Research	Uses the asset management letter because the role is portfolio construction, not deal work. https://jobs.partnersgroup.com/job/London-Portfolio-&-Quant-Analyst-%28new-graduate-level%29-London%2C-UK/1249662101
8	Howden Private Capital: Private Capital Portfolio Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake)	London	Open. Starts September 2027, £40,000, hybrid.	Banking PE Consulting	Howden allows only ONE graduate application for the 2027 intake. Barnett Waddingham, now part of Howden, has a Glasgow Investment Analyst grad role, so pick one. https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/private-capital-portfolio-solutions-graduate-programme-247259
9	Rede Partners: Analyst Programme	London	Annual intake. Apply by emailing your CV and cover letter to careers@rede-partners.com .	Banking PE Consulting	A cover letter is required here, so this one gets used as written. https://www.rede-partners.com/graduate-scheme
10	ICG: 2027 Graduate Programme (Investment)	London	2027 window not yet confirmed. ICG recruits on an autumn timetable with a small London	Banking PE Consulting	Check the page weekly, or set an alert on Trackr. https://www.icgam.com/people-

			cohort.		and-careers/early-careers/
SALES AND TRADING					
11	Macquarie: 2027 Commodities and Global Markets Graduate Programme	London	Open 1 September to 30 October 2026. For final-year students graduating in 2027; 12-month programme from July 2027.	Quant Trading	Best fit on the list. Apply this week. https://recruitment.macquarie.com/en_US/careers/JobDetail/2027-Commodities-and-Global-Markets-Graduate-Programme/23733
12	Citi: Markets – Sales and Trading, Full Time Analyst (2027)	London	Open (posted 4 September 2026).	Quant Trading	https://jobs.citi.com/job/london/markets-sales-and-trading-full-time-analyst-london-united-kingdom-2027/287/100186099392
13	BNP Paribas: 2027 Global Markets Graduate Analyst Programme	London	Open for students graduating between autumn 2026 and spring 2027.	Quant Trading	BNP allows ONE graduate programme per year (Global Banking, Global Markets, Technology or Securities Services). Choose the Trading or Sales track on the London posting. https://group.bnpparibas/en/careers/job-offer/2027-graduate-programme-global-markets
14	EDF Trading: Commercial Graduate Programme (September 2027)	London	Open. Virtual assessment centre in November 2026; £35,000; needs a 2:2 or above.	Quant Trading	EDF Energy also runs a 'Commercial Graduate' scheme (deadline 1 Oct, now closed). Make sure you apply to the EDF Trading one. https://ratemyplacement.co.uk/jobs/29511/edf-trading/commercial-graduate-programme
15	Goldman Sachs: 2027 EMEA London FICC and Equities (Sales and Trading) New Analyst Programme	London	New Analyst Programme open to 2027 graduates (one of your 4 GS choices).	Quant Trading	Confirm the London FICC & Equities posting on higher.gs.com . https://www.goldmansachs.com/careers/students/programs-and-internships/emea/new-analyst-programme
HEDGE FUNDS					
16	Point72: Point72 Academy Investment Analyst Program for Upcoming Graduates (2027 – UK)	London	Open for students graduating December 2026 to July 2027.	Asset Management Research	https://www.efinancialcareers.com/jobs-UK-London-Point72_Academy_Investment_Analyst_Program_for_Upcoming_Graduates_2027_-_UK.id24494396
17	Capula Investment Management: Analyst Programme	London	Two-year graduate programme with rotations across trading functions. Check capulaglobal.com/careers for the 2027 intake.	Quant Trading	Capula's 2027 summer internship accepts 2027 graduates, so apply to both if the Analyst Programme isn't open yet. https://capulaglobal.com/careers
18	Winton: Quantitative Researcher – Graduate: 2027	London	Open, London.	Quant Trading	Likely to favour maths, physics or CS. Lead with the econometrics on your CV. https://www.efinancialcareers.com/jobs-United_Kingdom-London-Quantitative_Researcher_-_Graduate_2027.id24569147
19	Man Group: Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake)	London	Listed (graduate programme with CFA support). Confirm the 2027 intake is live.	Asset Management Research	https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/solutions-graduate-programme-228274
20	Millennium: Graduate Analyst – Trading (Global Fixed Income, Currency and Commodities team)	London	NOT CONFIRMED OPEN. The listing found was from an earlier cycle.	Quant Trading	Lowest-confidence role on the list. Check before spending time on it. https://www.mlp.com/careers/
QUANT					
21	Susquehanna (SIG): Quantitative Trader – Graduate: 2027	London	Open, London (Dublin also hiring).	Quant Trading	Apply on careers.sig.com . https://www.tradermath.org/firms/sig/jobs/quantitative-trader-graduate-2027-in-london-7d4dab
22	Jane Street: Quantitative Trader (Full-Time, New Graduate)	London	Rolling, year-round. No fixed deadline.	Quant Trading	Jane Street often asks for no letter. Use the 150 to 250 word text-box version (opening paragraph, firm paragraph and one evidence sentence). https://www.janestreet.com/join

					-jane-street/open-roles/?type=students-and-new-grads&location=london
23	IMC Trading: Graduate Quantitative Trader (2027 start)	London or Amsterdam	Open. For students graduating September 2026 to July 2027; starts February or August 2027.	Quant Trading	State London as your preferred office. IMC treats location as a preference, not a guarantee. https://www.imc.com/us/careers/jobs/4751729101
24	Maven Securities: Graduate Trader Programme 2027	Amsterdam	Deadline 20 October 2026. Starts 6 September 2027.	Quant Trading	Urgent. Maven also lists a London Graduate Quant Researcher 2027 role (rolling). https://www.tradermath.org/firms/maven-securities/jobs/graduate-trader-programme-amsterdam-2027-in-amsterdam-4a758c
25	Optiver: Graduate Equity Analyst (2027 Start)	Amsterdam	Open (rolling, one application per role per year).	Quant Trading	Based in Amsterdam. Also check optiver.com for a London graduate trader posting. https://optiver.com/join-us/jobs/trading/amsterdam/graduate-equity-analyst-2027-start/
ASSET MANAGEMENT					
26	Baillie Gifford: Investment Research Graduate Programme 2027	Edinburgh	2027 recruitment live. Reported closing date 3 November 2026.	Asset Management Research	Confirm the closing date on Baillie Gifford's own page. https://www.bailliegifford.com/en/uk/individual-investors/careers/early-careers/graduate-programmes/
27	Fidelity International: Equity Research Graduate Programme 2027	London	Open. Closes 15 November 2026, 23:55 GMT (rolling).	Asset Management Research	Uses the equity research letter. The optional one-page stock note would help here. https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/equity-research-graduate-programme-2027-london-240539
28	Schroders: Wealth Management (Portfolio Management) Graduate Programme 2027	London	Open. Starts 16 September 2027.	Asset Management Research	The Cazenove trainee programme also has Edinburgh places. https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/schroders/wealth-management-portfolio-management-graduate-2027
29	Franklin Templeton: Futures Rotational Graduate Program – Investment Management (2027)	London	Open for recent graduates or those graduating in summer 2027.	Asset Management Research	Confirm the office for the Investment Management track. The Edinburgh posting is the Global Client Group track. https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/futures-rotational-graduate-program-investment-management-239001
30	Janus Henderson: Research Associate – Investment Graduate Programme 2027	London	Open, London. Starts summer 2027.	Asset Management Research	Uses the equity research letter. https://jobs.workable.com/jobs/5a36fdaf-5b9e-4fed-b252-9ad643148501
CONSULTING					
31	Oxford Economics: 2027 UK Graduate Programme	Belfast or London	Open. Reviewed on a rolling basis from 28 September 2026.	Banking PE Consulting	Belfast option. https://careers.oxfordeconomics.com/postings/abfbea50-2119-443b-8b0d-3d5696270143
32	FTI Consulting: 2027 Graduate Scheme – Economic & Financial Consulting	London	Open. Starts September 2027.	Banking PE Consulting	https://www.fticonsulting.com/careers
33	Oxera: Graduate Economics Analyst – Data Science and Econometrics	London	Graduate analyst roles listed across tracks.	Banking PE Consulting	Oxera often prefers a Master's. Ask whether a strong BA is considered, or apply to the Finance & Valuation track as well. https://www.oxera.com/careers/
34	Baringa: Graduate Analyst Programme – Energy & Resources	London	Graduate Analyst – Energy & Resources listed on Baringa's job board.	Banking PE Consulting	https://brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-employer-company/baringa
35	Capital Economics: Graduate Economist Scheme (September 2027)	London	Open. Reported deadline 16 October 2026. Wants a first or a strong 2:1 in Economics.	Banking PE Consulting	URGENT: 10 days left. https://www.capitaleconomics.com/careers/graduates

Will McGowan

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Lazard

50 Stratton Street

London W1J 8LL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 London Financial Advisory Full-Time Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Lazard's role advising SunOpta on its \$1.1 billion sale to Refresco in 2026 sits squarely in the food and agribusiness territory I have spent the past year analysing.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

Lazard's independent advisory model stands out to me because the firm's reputation rests on the quality of its advice, and its 2026 mandates range from NextEra Energy's combination with Dominion Energy, at a combined enterprise value of around \$420 billion the largest energy deal on record, to SunOpta's \$1.1 billion sale to Refresco. Having spent a year explaining agribusiness deals such as Olam Agri's stake sale to SALIC, and with a dissertation on European gas markets, I would welcome the chance to learn how Lazard's bankers frame rationale and valuation for boards in exactly these sectors.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

J.P. Morgan

25 Bank Street, Canary Wharf

London E14 5JP

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Global Investment Banking Analyst Program (Full-Time) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. J.P. Morgan's advisory work in energy, including its role on Sidara's acquisition of John Wood Group, completed in March 2026, connects directly to the energy-market research at the centre of my degree.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

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J.P. Morgan's Investment Banking franchise stands out to me because it pairs leading advisory work with the balance sheet to finance what it advises on; it was an adviser on Sidara's acquisition of John Wood Group, completed in March 2026 at an implied equity value of around £216 million, a deal where the value of an energy-services business had to be judged carefully. My dissertation on European gas volatility has shown me how quickly energy fundamentals feed into valuations, and I would like to bring that understanding, together with the deal analysis I practise with the Agricapital Society, to a J.P. Morgan deal team.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Houlihan Lokey

One Curzon Street

London W1J 5HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Financial Analyst – Corporate Finance (M&A) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Houlihan Lokey's deal volume, which made it LSEG's number one adviser by number of global M&A transactions in 2025, promises the breadth of live deal exposure I am looking for from the start.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

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Houlihan Lokey's corporate finance practice stands out to me because of its sheer deal flow: LSEG ranked it the number one adviser for global M&A by deal count in 2025, with 458 transactions. A mid-market focus means analysts see many deals from start to finish rather than a narrow slice of a few, and that is how I have learned best, by breaking down one transaction after another for Agricapital Society members until the patterns in rationale, structure and valuation became clear.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court, 25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 EMEA London Investment Banking New Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Goldman Sachs's role on Europe's largest deals this year, including advising Unilever on the sale of its food business to McCormick, is the kind of food and consumer work my agri-finance research has prepared me to understand.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

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Goldman Sachs's EMEA M&A franchise stands out to me because the firm advised on 44% of the region's M&A by value in the first half of 2026, its largest share in nearly a decade, including advising Unilever on the roughly \$45 billion sale of its food business to McCormick. Food and agribusiness transactions are exactly what I have spent the past year dissecting with the Agricapital Society, and I would value learning how a deal of that scale is put together, from the strategic case to the separation of the business.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Rothschild & Co

New Court, St Swithin's Lane

London EC4N 8AL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Evergreen – 2027 Global Advisory Graduate Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Rothschild & Co's role as joint lead financial adviser to McCormick on its combination with Unilever's Foods business, announced in March 2026, sits right where my interest in food and agribusiness transactions began.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

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Rothschild & Co's Global Advisory business stands out to me because its independence lets it lead complex cross-border transactions such as McCormick's \$66 billion combination with Unilever Foods, structured as a Reverse Morris Trust and described by the firm as the second-largest food transaction ever. Explaining why SALIC wanted a stake in Olam Agri taught me that the structure of a deal often matters as much as its headline value, and I would like to learn that craft from the bankers who design deals like this one.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
British International Investment
123 Victoria Street
London SW1E 6DE

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Investment and Impact Graduate Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. British International Investment's commitment to AFEX, Africa's leading commodities platform serving more than 450,000 farmers, connects directly to the agri-finance research I lead at Strathclyde.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

BII's food and agriculture investing stands out to me because it treats financial return and development impact as one discipline: its \$26.5 million commitment to AFEX backs a commodities platform running more than 200 warehouses across Nigeria, Kenya and Uganda, and in March 2026 it completed its first joint transaction with ILX to expand lending to East African agribusinesses. I co-founded the Agricapital Society because I believe agricultural markets are where finance can matter most, and a programme that rotates through both an investment team and the Impact group is exactly the training I want.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Partners Group (UK) Ltd
London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Portfolio & Quant Analyst (new graduate level) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Partners Group's Portfolio Solutions team, whose bespoke mandates drove most of the firm's record \$16 billion of new commitments in the first half of 2026, works on the question my research keeps returning to: how to build a portfolio whose risk is properly understood.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Partners Group's Portfolio Solutions team stands out to me because it covers the whole chain from relative-value views to portfolio construction and monitoring across private markets, and bespoke solutions made up a clear majority of the firm's record fundraising in the first half of 2026. Private assets make risk harder to measure because their prices are observed infrequently, and my work forecasting volatility with mixed-frequency data, alongside testing CAPM across 704 portfolios, has given me a grounding in exactly the econometrics that problem needs.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Howden

One Creechurch Place

London EC3A 5AF

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Private Capital Portfolio Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Howden Private Capital is a newly established global division serving private equity, private credit and infrastructure investors, and joining a team while it is still being built appeals to me as someone who co-founded a society from nothing.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

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Howden Private Capital stands out to me because it approaches private capital from the risk side, helping investors and portfolio companies manage risk as well as grow, and because it is newly established, so graduates join while its offering to sponsors is still taking shape. Building the Agricapital Society from launch to 126 members taught me how much a young organisation depends on people who will research, analyse and take ownership, and my sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's sale to SALIC have given me a working understanding of how private investors assess and protect value.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Rede Partners

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Rede Partners' work raising capital for private equity managers, including THL's \$6.35 billion Fund X, which closed in May 2026, would let me see private equity from the side of the investors who fund it.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

Rede Partners stands out to me because it sits between private equity managers and the institutions that back them, with rotations across advisory, origination, credit and transactions; in 2026 it advised on fundraises including THL Fund X at \$6.35 billion and Longship Fund IV, and its LP Pulse Check drew on conversations with 47 institutional investors about software exposure. The programme would let me apply what I practise each week with the Agricapital Society, turning research into a clear view for an audience, to the question every investor asks: why this manager, and why now.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

ICG

Procession House, 55 Ludgate Hill

London EC4M 7JW

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Programme (Investment) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. ICG's final close of Europe Fund IX at €12 billion in September 2026, which it describes as the largest dedicated structured capital fund raised globally, shows the kind of flexible capital I want to learn to structure.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

ICG's structured capital strategy stands out to me because it sits between debt and equity, so every investment has to be designed around the needs of a company and its owners; Europe Fund IX closed in September 2026 at €12 billion, 50% larger than its predecessor, with 77% of existing investors committing again. Analysing how Olam Agri's stake sale to SALIC was structured taught me that the shape of a deal can matter as much as its price, and I would like to learn that discipline at a firm that has made it a speciality.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Macquarie Group
Ropemaker Place, 28 Ropemaker Street
London EC2Y 9HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Commodities and Global Markets Graduate Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities, particularly gas and power. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Macquarie's recognition as Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards matters to me because European gas is the market my dissertation studies.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously; my lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 were built on disciplined bet sizing and a strict bankroll rule.

Macquarie's Commodities and Global Markets business stands out to me because it combines physical and financial expertise in gas, from the long-term LNG offtake agreements it signed with Texas LNG and AMIGO LNG in 2025 to the risk-management solutions it offers clients, and it was named Natural Gas/LNG House of the Year at the 2026 Energy Risk Awards. My dissertation measures how storage and news drive TTF volatility, and I would like to learn how those same drivers shape the hedges and prices Macquarie offers its clients.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Citi

Citigroup Centre, 25 Canada Square, Canary Wharf

London E14 5LB

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Markets – Sales and Trading, Full Time Analyst (2027) role in London, with a particular interest in commodities and macro. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Citi's Markets business grew fixed income revenue by 20% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, to \$4.27 billion, which shows a franchise clients turn to when markets move.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

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Citi's Markets franchise stands out to me because its fixed income revenue rose 20% year on year in the second quarter of 2026 on strong client flows in rates and currencies, and because its full-time analyst programme lets analysts rotate within a product before settling on a desk. I would hope to rotate across commodities and macro, where my work on gas volatility and the wheat calendar spread has given me a grounding in how fundamentals, positioning and risk interact.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

BNP Paribas

10 Harewood Avenue

London NW1 6AA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Global Markets Graduate Analyst Programme in London, with a particular interest in Global Macro, particularly commodities. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. BNP Paribas's Global Macro business, which covers FX, rates and commodities across developed and emerging markets, offers the breadth across asset classes I want at the start of my career.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

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BNP Paribas's Global Markets franchise stands out to me because its FICC business has driven the bank's results in 2026, with a sharp rise in FICC revenue in the first quarter, and because Global Macro offers the full spectrum of FX, rates and commodities products. Commodities are where my research sits, but my dissertation has shown me how closely gas prices are linked to currencies and rates through inflation and policy, and I would value a desk that sees those connections from the inside.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

EDF Trading

80 Victoria Street

London SW1E 5JL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Commercial Graduate Programme (September 2027) in London, with a particular interest in gas and power trading. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. EDF Trading's gas desk is one of the largest wholesale natural gas traders in Europe, and European gas is the market I have chosen to study in depth for my dissertation.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

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EDF Trading stands out to me because it sits where physical energy meets financial markets, with a gas trading team among Europe's largest wholesale traders and a power trading team that uses data analysis to find opportunities in the market. My dissertation forecasts TTF volatility from daily storage, market and news data, and I would like to learn how a trading business turns exactly those inputs into positions and hedges for one of Europe's largest generators.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court, 25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 EMEA London FICC and Equities (Sales and Trading) New Analyst Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Goldman Sachs's FICC business grew revenue 32% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, with commodities among the businesses driving the increase, and that is the part of the trading floor I most want to join.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

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Goldman Sachs's FICC franchise stands out to me because its scale across rates, currencies and commodities lets it keep making markets for clients through volatile periods; FICC net revenues reached \$4.59 billion in the second quarter of 2026, up 32% on the year, on higher activity in interest rate products, commodities and mortgages. My dissertation and wheat spread strategy have taught me how quickly commodity risk can change, and I would like to learn how a desk manages that risk while still giving clients a price.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Point72

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Point72 Academy Investment Analyst Program for Upcoming Graduates (2027 – UK) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. The Point72 Academy's ten-month programme, which teaches statistics, modelling and coding before analysts join investment teams, is the most structured route I have found from academic research to holding a real investment view.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. My lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 came from respecting variance and sizing risk to a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and as Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

The Point72 Academy stands out to me because it treats training as a real investment: eight months of formal teaching in company analysis, modelling, data analysis and coding, followed by rotations with investment teams, with more than 230 Academy graduates placed at the firm as of March 2026. My CAPM work showed me how rarely an apparent edge survives proper testing, and I would like to learn how Point72's analysts build fundamental views that do.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Capula Investment Management LLP
London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Capula's launch of a systematic commodities fund in 2026, its first major move beyond fixed income, overlaps directly with my own commodity research.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

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Capula stands out to me because it is extending a rigorous, quantitative approach from bonds and currencies into raw materials: its new Capula Alternative Markets Alpha Fund trades commodities algorithmically, with room for \$2 billion to \$3 billion of capital. My dissertation tests whether storage and news data improve forecasts of gas volatility, and whether better forecasts survive a realistic trading test, and I would like to learn how a firm with Capula's discipline turns that kind of research into risk across its trading functions.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Winton

Grove House, 27 Hammersmith Grove

London W6 0NE

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Researcher – Graduate: 2027 role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Winton's focus on statistical inference in financial markets describes the work I most enjoy, and its trend-following research is close to the forecasting and backtesting I do myself.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

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Winton stands out to me because it has built its business on statistical inference rather than narrative, and it keeps extending that research into new formats, bringing its flagship major-market trend strategy to a US mutual fund for the first time in October 2025. Benchmarking my gas volatility models out-of-sample with Diebold-Mariano tests, across pre-crisis, crisis and post-crisis periods, has taught me to distrust any result that has not survived unseen data, which I understand is the standard Winton's researchers work to.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Man Group
Riverbank House, 2 Swan Lane
London EC4R 3AD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Man Group's Solutions programme, which rotates graduates through portfolio management, quant and advisory teams, would let me apply my asset-pricing research to the portfolios clients actually hold.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

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Man Group stands out to me because it runs systematic and discretionary investing on one platform, and clients have responded: assets under management reached a record \$253.6 billion at the end of June 2026, with \$7.1 billion of net inflows in the first half. The Solutions programme's mix of portfolio management, quant and advisory rotations fits how I like to work, from testing which factor premia survive across 56 countries to explaining the results to people who need to act on them.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Millennium Capital Management (UK) LLP

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Analyst – Trading (Global Fixed Income, Currency and Commodities team) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Millennium's commitment to commodities, where natural gas trading drove much of its gains in 2023 and 2024, matches the market I know best.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

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Millennium stands out to me because its platform gives individual teams real responsibility for risk, and its commitment to commodities runs deep, from the natural gas trading behind much of its commodities profit in 2023 and 2024 to its \$1.5 billion backing of the Echion Capital commodities spin-out. A graduate role that mixes trading, research and software development across fixed income, currency and commodity markets suits someone whose dissertation is on TTF gas and whose work runs on code.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Susquehanna International Group
34th Floor, 110 Bishopsgate
London EC2N 4AY

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Trader – Graduate: 2027 role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Susquehanna's training in game theory and decision-making under uncertainty appeals to me because those are the skills behind my results at the poker table.

Most of what I am proudest of comes down to good decisions made with incomplete information. My lifetime poker cash-game winnings of over £40,000 came from expected-value reasoning, disciplined bet sizing and a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and I finished 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships in 2023. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool.

I pair that instinct with quantitative work I can defend line by line. I built a Monte Carlo option pricer in which a geometric-Asian control variate cut the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% at 100,000 paths, and my dissertation forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models, testing whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. Proprietary trading appeals to me because the feedback is immediate and impartial: every decision is priced, and improving means learning faster than the market. Nearly two years of busy bar shifts alongside full-time study, and now running the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, have taught me to stay accurate when speed matters.

Susquehanna stands out to me because its graduate traders are embedded on a desk and managing risk within the first few months, after an education covering options and ETF trading, game theory and programming, and because its London office is still growing. My Monte Carlo pricing engine, benchmarked against Black-Scholes, gave me a first look at how volatility drives option value, and I would like to learn to apply that on a desk where every decision is priced.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Jane Street

2½ Devonshire Square

London EC2M 4UJ

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Quantitative Trader (Full-Time, New Graduate) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Jane Street's view that how you think matters more than what you already know is why I am applying as an economist rather than a mathematician.

Most of what I am proudest of comes down to good decisions made with incomplete information. My lifetime poker cash-game winnings of over £40,000 came from expected-value reasoning, disciplined bet sizing and a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and I finished 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships in 2023. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool.

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Jane Street stands out to me because it gives new traders significant responsibility within weeks to months, backed by a year-long firmwide curriculum, and because its London presence is growing, with an offer placed on a new office that would double its footprint. I would bring the habit my own research has taught me, testing whether an apparent edge survives costs; my wheat spread's Sharpe ratio fell from 0.76 to 0.28 once I did.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

IMC Trading

Amstelveenseweg 500

1081 KL Amsterdam

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Quantitative Trader (2027 start) role in London or Amsterdam. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. IMC's graduate programme explicitly welcomes econometrics students and values Python, MATLAB or R, which matches how I have trained myself to think about markets.

Most of what I am proudest of comes down to good decisions made with incomplete information. My lifetime poker cash-game winnings of over £40,000 came from expected-value reasoning, disciplined bet sizing and a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and I finished 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships in 2023. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool.

I pair that instinct with quantitative work I can defend line by line. I built a Monte Carlo option pricer in which a geometric-Asian control variate cut the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% at 100,000 paths, and my dissertation forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models, testing whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. Proprietary trading appeals to me because the feedback is immediate and impartial: every decision is priced, and improving means learning faster than the market. Nearly two years of busy bar shifts alongside full-time study, and now running the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, have taught me to stay accurate when speed matters.

IMC stands out to me because its trading teams span discretionary, systematic and execution-focused roles, and graduates are placed where their strengths fit after a six-week Global Trainee Programme, at a firm that hired more than 450 people in 2025. My strengths are time-series econometrics and simulation, built in R and MATLAB through my dissertation and option pricer, and I would like to discover where on IMC's desks they add the most value.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Maven Securities
Amsterdam

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Trader Programme 2027 in Amsterdam. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Maven's options market making, where it is consistently ranked among the top three liquidity providers on the exchanges it trades, is the business I want to learn.

Most of what I am proudest of comes down to good decisions made with incomplete information. My lifetime poker cash-game winnings of over £40,000 came from expected-value reasoning, disciplined bet sizing and a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and I finished 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships in 2023. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool.

I pair that instinct with quantitative work I can defend line by line. I built a Monte Carlo option pricer in which a geometric-Asian control variate cut the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% at 100,000 paths, and my dissertation forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models, testing whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. Proprietary trading appeals to me because the feedback is immediate and impartial: every decision is priced, and improving means learning faster than the market. Nearly two years of busy bar shifts alongside full-time study, and now running the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, have taught me to stay accurate when speed matters.

Maven Securities stands out to me because it combines the reach of a top-three liquidity provider in listed options and futures with a size where a graduate's contribution is visible, and its programme begins with eleven weeks of structured training in London. Building my Monte Carlo pricer gave me a first-hand feel for how option values respond to volatility, and I would like to turn that understanding into quoting real markets.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Optiver

Strawinskylaan 3095

1077 ZX Amsterdam

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Equity Analyst (2027 Start) role in Amsterdam. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1, and my strongest work sits where econometrics meets code. Optiver's Equity Analysts use current events and fundamental research to shape options trading decisions, which is the question my dissertation asks of the gas market: how much does news move volatility?

My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether the news pays when forecasting European gas volatility. I am building a mixed-frequency (MIDAS) model in MATLAB that combines daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends. I will evaluate it out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks using Diebold-Mariano tests, then compare the Sharpe ratios of a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy built on each model. Earlier, I built a Monte Carlo option pricer in which a geometric-Asian control variate cut the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% at 100,000 paths, and tested corn and soybean prices for cointegration in R. I work mainly in R and MATLAB and am strengthening my Python.

Quantitative research appeals to me because it is honest: an idea only counts if it survives data it has not seen. Poker taught me the same respect for variance; my lifetime cash-game winnings of over £40,000 came from disciplined bet sizing and a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule rather than any single good night. I brought that discipline to the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I co-founded and grew to 126 members, where I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after.

Optiver's Equity Options Trading team stands out to me because its analysts sit on the trading floor and see their research tested against live volatility, starting with training through the Optiver Academy for Equity Analysts. Building a news-attention index has taught me how hard it is to separate information that moves volatility from noise, and I would like to apply that discipline to company events and the options priced on them.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Baillie Gifford & Co
Calton Square, 1 Greenside Row
Edinburgh EH1 3AN

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Investment Research Graduate Programme 2027 in Edinburgh. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Baillie Gifford's patience as a long-term growth investor, able to hold companies through both their private and public lives, is the opposite of the short-term noise my research tries to filter out.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Baillie Gifford stands out to me because its partnership structure lets it judge companies over five and ten years rather than quarters, and trusts such as Scottish Mortgage can back businesses through their private and public lifetimes. My factor research found that most apparent anomalies weaken under proper testing, which makes me respect a process built on deep company research held over long horizons, and I would be glad to learn it in Edinburgh, an hour from where I study.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Fidelity International

4 Cannon Street

London EC4M 5AB

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Equity Research Graduate Programme 2027 in London, with a particular interest in energy and materials coverage. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Fidelity's research model, in which its analysts hold more than 20,000 company meetings a year, is the kind of primary research I want to learn to do.

Equity research rewards a view that is stated plainly and tested honestly, and that is how I try to work. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility: I am building mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models from daily storage, market and news-based data, testing them out-of-sample against established benchmarks and asking whether better forecasts carry economic value. I also tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries, finding that momentum and value alphas survive statistical scrutiny far more often than size, and my final-year modules include Industrial Economics and Natural Resource, Environmental and Energy Economics, which give me a framework for how industries compete.

What draws me to research is the writing as much as the analysis: a note is only useful if a busy reader can act on it. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I published weekly research notes and dashboards and led sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining each to members from outside finance.

Fidelity International's research platform stands out to me because its analysts speak to a company's management roughly every ten minutes of every working day, and because it publishes their collective view in its annual Analyst Survey, whose 2026 edition covers energy prices, rare earth metals and the effect of geopolitics on company earnings. Those are the themes I study through European gas markets, and I would like to learn how Fidelity's analysts turn company meetings into a view a portfolio manager can act on.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

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9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Schroders

1 London Wall Place

London EC2Y 5AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Wealth Management (Portfolio Management) Graduate Programme 2027 in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Cazenove Capital's £1.9 billion of net new business in the second quarter of 2026 shows a wealth franchise growing on the strength of the discretionary portfolio management this programme trains graduates to do.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Schroders Wealth Management stands out to me because it is investing in its future: Cazenove Capital generated £1.9 billion of net new business in the second quarter of 2026, it launched a Global Wealth Advisory service for ultra-high net worth clients in July, and it has significantly increased its graduate intake. Portfolio management for private clients and charities joins two things I care about, rigorous risk analysis and explaining it plainly, which I practise each week in research notes for Agricapital Society members.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

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+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Franklin Templeton
Cannon Place, 78 Cannon Street
London EC4N 6HL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Futures Rotational Graduate Program – Investment Management (2027) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Franklin Templeton's Futures Program, which rotates graduates across investment teams that use data and digital tools alongside fundamental research, suits an economist whose research runs on code.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Franklin Templeton stands out to me because of its breadth across public and private markets and its continuing commitment to Scotland, where its Edinburgh office houses several portfolio management teams as the Martin Currie teams move under ClearBridge and Franklin Equity Group. A rotational programme would let me test where my strengths fit best, from the factor research behind my CAPM study to the risk forecasting in my dissertation.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Janus Henderson Investors

201 Bishopsgate

London EC2M 3AE

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Research Associate – Investment Graduate Programme 2027 in London, with a particular interest in energy and industrials coverage. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Janus Henderson's two-year immersion in its equities team, built on research that combines quantitative financial analysis with qualitative judgement, is the training I want.

Equity research rewards a view that is stated plainly and tested honestly, and that is how I try to work. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility: I am building mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models from daily storage, market and news-based data, testing them out-of-sample against established benchmarks and asking whether better forecasts carry economic value. I also tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries, finding that momentum and value alphas survive statistical scrutiny far more often than size, and my final-year modules include Industrial Economics and Natural Resource, Environmental and Energy Economics, which give me a framework for how industries compete.

What draws me to research is the writing as much as the analysis: a note is only useful if a busy reader can act on it. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I published weekly research notes and dashboards and led sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining each to members from outside finance.

Janus Henderson stands out to me because it is moving into private ownership under Trian and General Catalyst after regulators approved the deal in June 2026, keeping its management team and London headquarters and giving its equity teams room to think long term. The programme's blend of quantitative financial analysis and qualitative research matches how I work: my CAPM study tested 704 portfolios statistically, but explaining deals such as Olam Agri's stake sale to SALIC taught me that numbers only matter once you understand the business behind them.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Oxford Economics

4 Millbank

London SW1P 3JA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 UK Graduate Programme in Belfast or London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Oxford Economics' Global Economic Model, which links 80 countries and is relied on by more than 200 organisations, is the most ambitious version of the empirical modelling I have come to enjoy.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Oxford Economics stands out to me because its forecasts rest on a globally integrated model and are willing to differ from the consensus; in April 2026 its global macro team put world growth at 2.9% against the IMF's 3.1% and expected Brent crude to average \$90 a barrel, around \$10 above the IMF's implied assumption. Energy prices are central to my dissertation, and two years of six-month rotations, with the option of a Belfast base where I grew up, make this an unusually strong fit.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
FTI Consulting
200 Aldersgate, Aldersgate Street
London EC1A 4HD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Scheme – Economic & Financial Consulting in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. FTI Consulting's investment in energy expertise within Economic and Financial Consulting, including the appointment of energy economist Emmanuel Fages in July 2026, matches the energy-market research I am doing.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

FTI Consulting's Economic and Financial Consulting practice stands out to me because its analysis has to survive scrutiny from opposing experts, tribunals and regulators, and because it is building out its energy advice, appointing Emmanuel Fages, an energy economist with more than 30 years' experience across utilities and financial energy markets, in July 2026. Testing my gas volatility models against benchmarks with formal statistical tests has taught me to build analysis that can be defended line by line.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Oxera

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Economics Analyst – Data Science and Econometrics role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Oxera's dedicated Data Science and Econometrics track asks for exactly the empirical skills I have built in R, MATLAB and Python.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Oxera stands out to me because its graduate analysts apply serious empirical analysis to live competition, regulation and valuation questions, with dedicated tracks in data science and econometrics, finance and valuation, and competition and market design. My dissertation combines mixed-frequency econometrics with a new text-based data source, and my CAPM study ran asset-pricing tests across 56 countries; I would like to bring those skills to questions where the answer shapes a regulator's decision.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Baringa

62 Buckingham Gate

London SW1E 6AJ

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Analyst Programme – Energy & Resources in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Baringa's energy market work, including the Future of Gas report it prepared for Ireland's Commission for Regulation of Utilities in 2026, connects directly to my dissertation on European gas.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Baringa's Energy and Resources practice stands out to me because it combines strategy advice with deep market modelling, and its Future of Gas work for Ireland's energy regulator shows it shaping the questions that will define how Europe's gas system is run. My dissertation models how storage, market data and news drive TTF volatility, and I would like to help clients turn that kind of analysis into decisions on investment and risk.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Capital Economics
Leconfield House, Curzon Street
London W1J 5JA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Economist Scheme (September 2027) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Capital Economics' recognition by FocusEconomics as the world's most accurate commodities forecaster speaks to the forecasting discipline my dissertation is built around.

The work I am proudest of follows a consulting arc: diagnose with data, recommend a change, then make it happen. At KONG, I analysed sales patterns and used them to refine our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge in Glasgow, I created the house cocktails and set the specifications for its classics from launch, wrote the batch specifications the team works to, and trained around 15 bar staff, several new to cocktail bartending, to deliver them consistently.

Consulting appeals to me for the range of problems and the standard of thinking it demands: a recommendation has to be structured, evidenced and clear enough for a client to act on. My dissertation applies the same discipline to a broad question, whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility, by breaking it into testable parts using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models and out-of-sample comparisons against benchmarks. In co-founding the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I built an organisation from launch to 126 members and led weekly sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC.

Capital Economics stands out to me because its independence lets it publish clear, testable calls, and its record can be checked: FocusEconomics named it the most accurate forecaster of commodity prices, including WTI crude oil and liquefied natural gas. Forecasting gas volatility out-of-sample has taught me how humbling a forecast record can be, and a two-year trainee scheme with rotations across four teams and support for postgraduate study is exactly the applied macroeconomics training I want.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan